

CrimeLifecycle

Guidance for generating Design Against Crime ideas

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Design Against Crime Solution Centre

The University of Salford



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Introduction

Models of criminal causality

A great deal has been written about the causes of crime by criminologists, and we have a fairly good understanding of the various *causal factors* that result in the occurrence of crime. In general, the causal factors for particular crimes are offender-focused and can be divided into two main areas:

- Those factors relating to the attributes of the offender that commits the crime
- Those factors relating to the attributes of the situation in which the crime happens

The aim of categorising the causal factors that underpin crime is to enable a better understanding of the influences and choices affecting offender behaviour in a crime situation.

This design resource is derived from one such causal framework, developed by Paul Ekblom at the UK Home Office (Ekblom, 2001). Ekblom's framework has been adapted and extended to create the DAC Crime Lifecycle Model, intended for use by designers during concept design development. Before describing the use of the crime lifecycle model, we will briefly explain the thinking that underpins it.

Active versus passive design

If crime is not effectively considered during the design of a product, place or environment then, from a crime prevention perspective, the design can be said to be *passive*. By this we mean that the finished design will be passively subject to the offender-related attributes and situation-related attributes that lead to crime, as illustrated in figure 1, below.

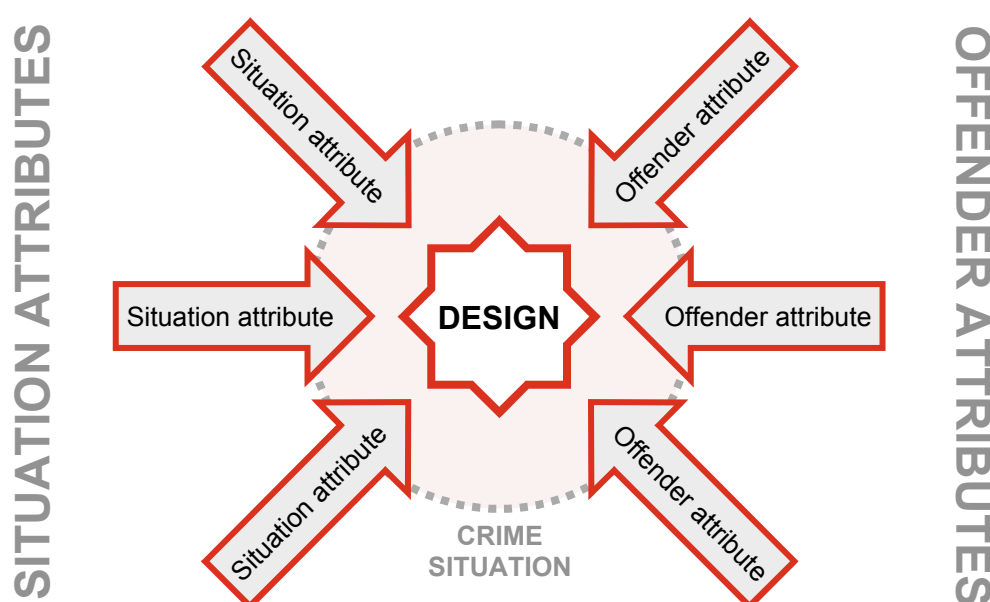


Figure 1 Passive design

Passive designs are more likely to require the *retrofitting* of security or crime prevention measures. This is often considerably more expensive than the cost of addressing crime during the design process.

Conversely, if designers consider crime effectively during development, then design attributes that counter or *block* offender- and situation-related attributes that lead to crime can be integrated within their design. From a crime prevention perspective, such designs can be considered *active* (as shown in figure 2), and are much less likely to require the expensive retrofitting of security or crime prevention measures.

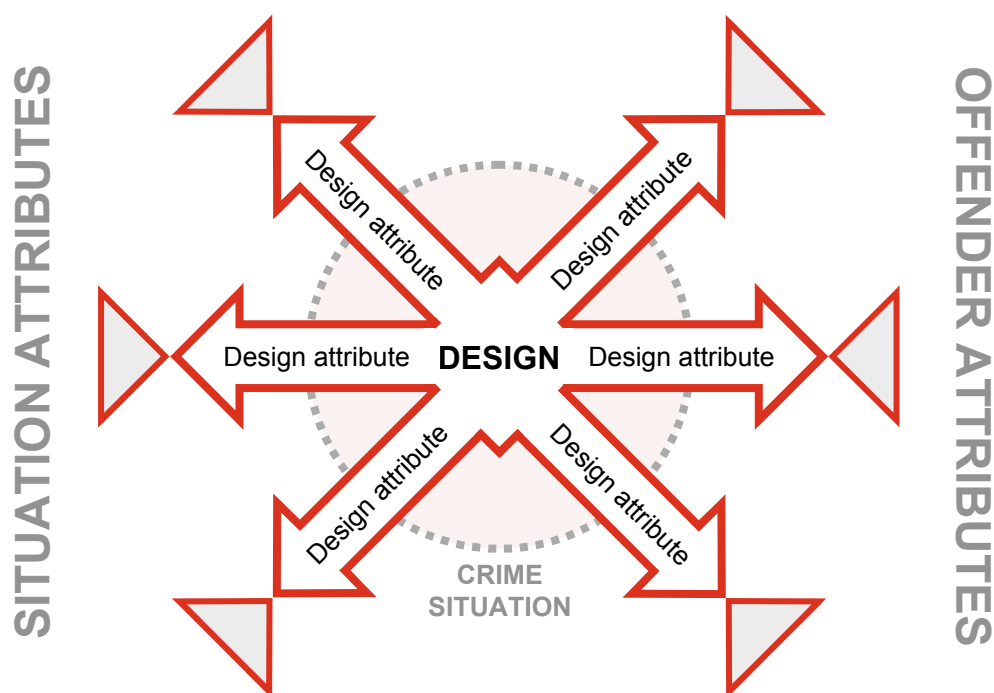


Figure 2 Active design

To summarise, designers should *design crime prevention in* and create active designs, rather than producing passive designs that require crime to be designed out at a later date.

Thinking beyond the crime event

Of course, not all crime can be prevented by design. Criminals are becoming ever more creative in the countermeasures they employ against crime prevention measures. So given that some crime will 'get through' any design-led prevention, it's sensible for designers to also embody measures within their designs that consider issues beyond the crime event, including:

- Helping identify, apprehend and prosecute offenders
- Mitigating against the short- and long-term effects of crime—both for the victim and the offender.

The Crime Lifecycle model

Based on the thinking outlined above, a *lifecycle* model for crime has been developed to help design professionals address crime issues during the development of design concepts (see figure 3)

The Crime Lifecycle Model embodies three key principles:

1. *Offending behaviour can breed further offending behaviour, so the real key to sustainable crime prevention is to break this cycle*

The initial and final phases of the model are linked, as a basic 'readiness to offend' is fuelled largely by a potential offender's life circumstances and the extent to which they believe criminal behaviour to be acceptable and a valid option for them. The longer-term consequences of criminal activity will impact on an offender's readiness to offend. For example, the difficulties of finding employment experienced by those with a criminal record may encourage further criminal behaviour. In addition, being locked up with a large number of other criminals may provide an education in criminal skills, and access to resources for future activities.

2. *All 6 Pre-Crime Issues (Phases 1 to 6) are prerequisite to a crime event occurring*

By *comprehensively* addressing any one of these issues, the crime event can effectively be prevented from occurring. Designers do not have to tackle all of the pre-crime issues, but can choose to concentrate on the ones that can be most effectively addressed.

3. Post-Crime Issues should also be considered

As already mentioned, it's unlikely that any crime prevention measure will be 100% effective. Therefore, it is important to consider how the product, service or environment might be designed to address issues that arise after the crime event. These are dealt with in Phases 7 to 10 of the lifecycle.

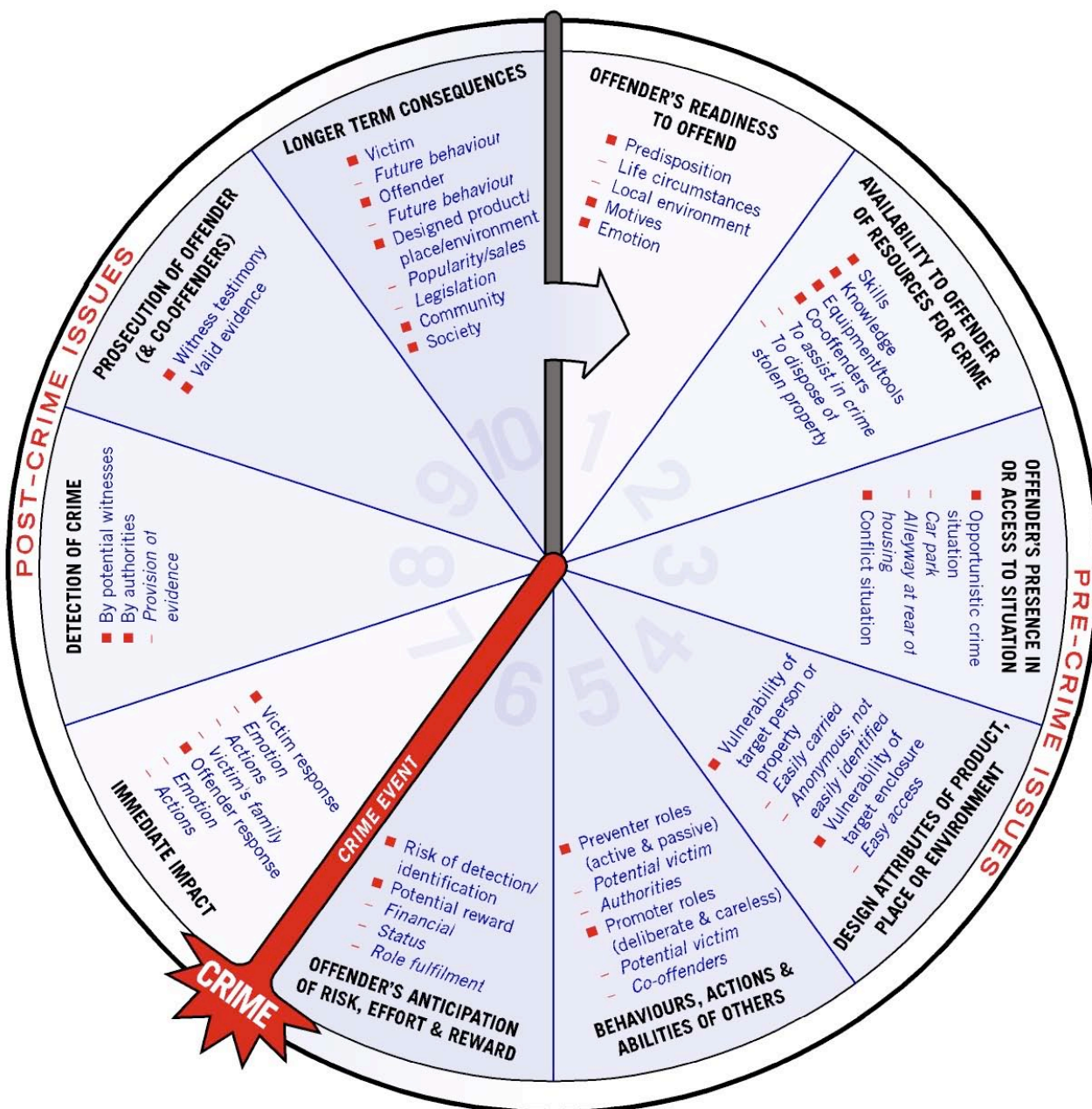


Figure 3 The Crime Lifecycle Model

Using the lifecycle model in the Design Against Crime process

The Design Against Crime process has four steps that follow the conventional course of designing a product, service or environment.

STEP 1 Consult

Gain support for, and input into, the Design Against Crime process from stakeholders within and outside the organisation

STEP 2 Develop

Research the possible risks and crime problems associated with the product, service or environment being designed. This understanding should inform the development of an appropriate design solution

STEP 3 Test

Design solutions must be validated fully before being made available or put on the market, to ensure they address crimes identified in Step 2.

STEP 4 Deliver

The client/customer response to the Design Against Crime solution, as well as the response from offenders, should be evaluated. Such feedback will inform future design efforts.

The Crime Lifecycle Model is designed for use during Step 2, to aid in understanding how the design of the product, service or environment being developed might address pre-crime and post-crime issues.

More detail about the Design Against Crime process can be found in *'Think Thief: A designer's guide to designing out crime'* published by the Design Council (2003).

Types of Crime

Designers will need to be aware of the range of crimes that might affect a new product, service or environment they are developing. Notifiable offences as categorised by the UK Home Office are given in table 1, below.

OFFENCE GROUPS	
1. Theft/handling stolen goods Including: – <i>Theft from vehicle</i> – <i>Theft or unauthorised taking of a motor vehicle</i> – <i>Vehicle crime</i> – <i>Other Theft</i> – <i>Theft from shop</i> – <i>Theft of pedal cycle</i> – <i>Theft from person</i> – <i>Handling Stolen Goods</i>	4. Violence against person Including: – <i>Less serious offences</i> – <i>More serious offences</i>
2. Burglary Including: – <i>Burglary in a dwelling</i> – <i>Burglary in other building</i>	5. Fraud and Forgery
3. Criminal damage Including: – <i>Arson</i> – <i>Other criminal damage</i>	6. Robbery
	7. Other 'notifiable offences' Including: – <i>Trafficking in controlled drugs</i> – <i>Going equipped for stealing</i> – <i>Other offences</i>
	8. Sexual offences Including: – <i>Rape</i> – <i>Indecent assault on a female</i> – <i>Other sexual offences</i>

Adapted from Home Office 1998, Criminal Statistics, England and Wales, London: HMSO

Table 1 Notifiable offences recorded by the police

Design-led solutions can be applied to every kind of crime, not just to 'opportunistic' or acquisitive property offences. Design has successfully tackled more calculated or deeply-motivated crimes, as well as ones committed by hardened offenders (e.g. hijacking, homicide and sexual harassment).

How to use the lifecycle model to generate ideas

With your design solution in mind—as well as the types of crimes that might be directed at it—work through the following ten stages of the Crime Lifecycle Model answering the questions and jotting any ideas down in the space provided.

TIME ISSUES

PROSECUTION OF OFFENDER (& CO-OFFENDERS)

- Witness testimony
- Valid evidence

LONGER TERM CONSEQUENCES

- Victim
- Future behaviour
- Offender
- Future product/
- place/environment
- Popularity/sales
- Legislation
- Community
- Society

OFFENDER'S READINESS TO OFFEND

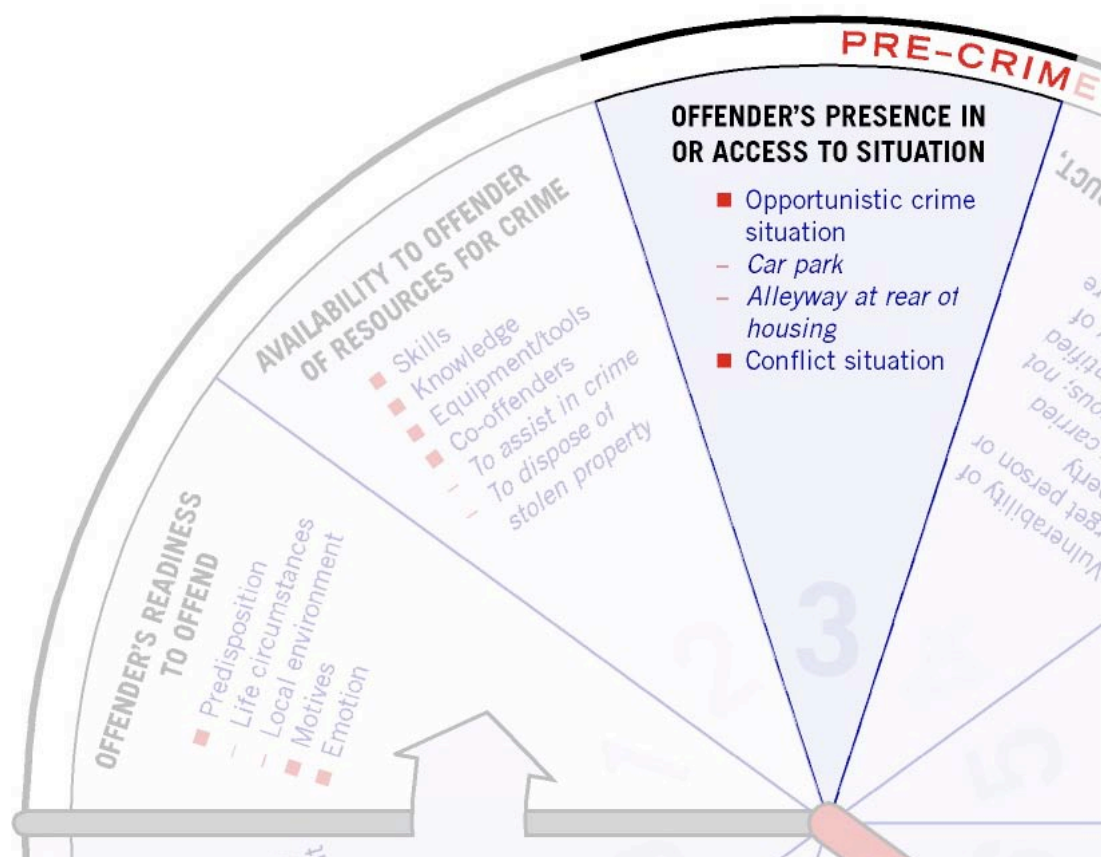
- Predisposition
- Life circumstances
- Local environment
- Motives
- Emotion

- Financial situation
- Educational background
- Employment
- Family situation
- Sense of 'belonging'

A large rectangular area filled with a light blue grid pattern, intended for generating Design Against Crime ideas. The grid is composed of small squares and is enclosed within a thin red border.

A large grid of graph paper, consisting of 20 columns and 30 rows of small squares, enclosed in a red border. The grid is intended for generating Design Against Crime ideas.

Issue 3: Offender's presence in, or access to, situation where offending may occur



Crime or conflict situations require the presence of an offender. Such presence may be:

- Purposeful (e.g. presence in a bank for a planned robbery)
- Opportunistic (e.g. presence in a crowded bar where a fight occurs).

QUESTION: Regarding your design, what are the potential crime and conflict situations that may occur? How might your design reduce the likelihood of an offender being present in such situations?

A full-page view of a blank sheet of graph paper. The paper features a uniform grid of small squares formed by thin, light blue horizontal and vertical lines. The grid covers the entire area of the page, leaving no margins or other markings.

A large rectangular area filled with a light blue grid pattern, intended for generating ideas. The grid consists of small squares and is enclosed within a thin red border.

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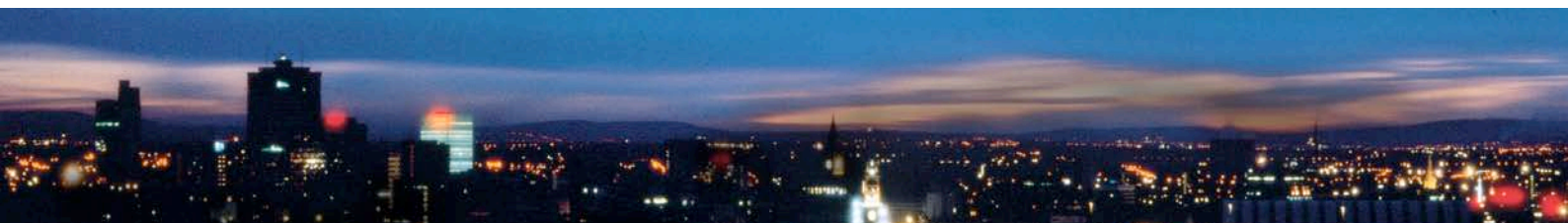
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Design Against Crime is an international programme of research and policy initiatives that aims to embed crime prevention within design through education and professional practice. The programme is directed by the *Design Policy Partnership*—a multi-disciplinary team of researchers at the University of Salford, Sheffield Hallam University and Robert Gordon University.

Visit the Design Against Crime website at <http://www.designagainstcrime.net>





A great deal has been written about the causes of crime by criminologists, and we have a fairly good understanding of the various causal factors that result in the occurrence of crime.

This design resource adapts and extends thinking from criminology and crime prevention to create the Crime Lifecycle Model. The Crime Lifecycle is intended for use by designers during concept design development to generate ideas and test solutions.

This publication was developed as part of the ongoing, international research programme *Design Against Crime* at the University of Salford.

www.designagainstcrime.net

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